

CARIBBEAN EARNER SERIES



# HARDWOOD RESTORATION BLUEPRINT

RESTORE IT. TRANSFORM IT. COMMAND PREMIUM RATES.



REAL SKILLS.



REAL INCOME.



NO HYPE.



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# Hardwood Floor Restoration Blueprint

Build a \$6,000–\$12,000/Month Hardwood Floor Restoration Business

- 1 Why Hardwood Floor Restoration Pays So Well**  
One floor transformation. One weekend. Caribbean homeowners pay \$800–\$3,000 per job.
- 2 The Restoration Process — Sanding, Staining, and Finishing**  
Step-by-step from damaged floor to showroom finish
- 3 Equipment — Renting vs Buying and What You Need First**  
Drum sander, edge sander, buffer, and the chemical lineup for every job
- 4 Your Service Menu — From Basic Refinishing to Full Restoration**  
Buffing, screen-and-recoat, full sand-and-finish, and repair services
- 5 Getting Clients — Caribbean Homeowners with Wood Floors**  
Where to find clients and how before-and-after photos fill your calendar
- 6 Scaling to a Full Flooring Business**  
Crew, installation services, commercial contracts, and the income that compounds

## INCOME BENCHMARKS

\$800–\$3,000 per job · 3 jobs/week = \$2,400–\$9,000 weekly · Caribbean homeowners invest heavily in flooring · before-and-after photos generate the highest booking conversion of any home service

# Why Hardwood Floor Restoration Pays So Well

**One floor transformation. One weekend. \$800–\$3,000 per job.**

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Hardwood floors are one of the most valuable features in any Caribbean home — and one of the most neglected. Years of traffic, furniture drag marks, pet scratches, water stains, and fading turn beautiful hardwood into an embarrassment that homeowners cover with rugs and apologize for when guests visit. A professional hardwood restoration transforms that embarrassment into the home's most beautiful feature in a single weekend. That transformation is worth \$800–\$3,000 to a Caribbean homeowner who invested significantly in those floors — and they will tell every neighbor, church member, and family friend who admires the result exactly who did the work.

**\$2,500**

Average hardwood restoration job · 400 sq ft floor · Caribbean homeowners invest in their properties · before-and-after photos are the most viral content in home services

## Why Caribbean Homeowners Are Your Premium Market

Caribbean homeowners who own properties with hardwood floors treat those floors as a significant investment. A Caribbean family that purchased a home with original oak hardwood, watched it deteriorate over 15 years under throw rugs, and is now shown a before-and-after photo of an identical floor restored to showroom condition responds with immediate emotional and financial commitment. They have been meaning to restore those floors for years. You are the professional who finally makes it happen.

### High ticket, high margin

A 400 sq ft floor restoration at \$2.50/sq ft = \$1,000 in revenue. Equipment rental: \$150. Supplies: \$80. Time: 2 days. Net: \$770 from one job. Three jobs per week = \$2,310 net weekly.

### Referral-driven growth

A restored hardwood floor is the most visible, most commented-on home improvement a Caribbean homeowner can make. Every guest who sees it asks who did it. Every social media post of the finished floor tags your business. Hardwood restoration is self-advertising.

### CARIBBEAN EARNER PRINCIPLE

Barbados built the most enduring plantation great houses in the Caribbean from local materials maintained with expert craftsmanship over centuries. Caribbean homeowners carry that same investment mindset — they build for the long term and they maintain what they own. When you restore a Caribbean home's hardwood floors to their original beauty, you are participating in a tradition of caring for what was built to last. That care generates the deepest client loyalty in any home service business.



# The Restoration Process — Sanding, Staining, and Finishing

Step-by-step from damaged floor to showroom finish.

Hardwood floor restoration follows a precise sequence. Each step builds on the previous one — skipping or rushing any stage produces a substandard result that is visible in every lighting condition. Master the sequence and every floor you touch becomes a portfolio piece that sells your next job.

**1****Assessment and Preparation**

Inspect the floor before quoting. Check wood thickness (minimum 3/4 inch for full sanding), identify repairs needed (loose boards, squeaks, missing pieces), note stain color if matching is required, and identify any areas with water damage or cupping that need special attention. Remove all furniture from the area. Cover doorways with plastic sheating to contain dust. Tape over HVAC vents to prevent dust circulation through the home.

**2****Coarse Sanding — Strip to Bare Wood**

Use a drum sander with 36-grit paper for the first pass — this removes the existing finish, stain, and surface scratches down to bare wood. Sand with the grain. Never stop the drum sander while it is running on the floor — it will sand a depression in seconds. Use an edge sander (36-grit) immediately after the drum sander to sand the perimeter areas the drum cannot reach. Hand scrape corners and closets. First pass is the most critical — take your time.

**3****Progressive Sanding — 60-Grit Then 80-Grit**

Follow the coarse sand with a 60-grit pass to remove the scratch marks left by 36-grit. Follow with an 80-grit final sand to produce a smooth, even surface ready for staining. Each progressive grit removes the scratch pattern of the previous grit. Between each pass, vacuum the entire floor thoroughly and wipe with a tack cloth to remove all dust before proceeding.

**4****Staining — Color Application**

If the client wants stain (color change), apply with a lambswool applicator and wipe immediately with rags to achieve even penetration. Test stain color in a closet or inconspicuous area and show the client the dried result before applying to the full floor. Caribbean clients often request warm honey, rich walnut, or classic golden oak tones that complement Caribbean interior design aesthetics. Allow full drying time per manufacturer specification before proceeding.

**5****Finish Coats — Three Coats for Durability**

Apply three coats of polyurethane (water-based or oil-based) with a light buff between each coat using a pole sander with 120-grit screen. Water-based polyurethane dries faster (2–4 hours between coats) and has lower odor. Oil-based polyurethane produces a warmer amber tone and higher durability. Caribbean clients often prefer oil-based for the traditional hardwood look it produces. Final coat: 48-hour cure before furniture replacement, 7-day full cure before area rugs.

# Equipment — Renting vs Buying and What You Need First

**Drum sander, edge sander, buffer, and the chemical lineup.**

Hardwood floor equipment is expensive to purchase but widely available to rent from Home Depot and specialty flooring equipment rental companies. Start by renting on every job — the rental cost is a small fraction of your job revenue and eliminates the capital investment risk while you build your client base.

| Equipment                     | Rental/Day    | Purchase Price      | Stage to Buy              |
|-------------------------------|---------------|---------------------|---------------------------|
| Drum floor sander             | \$65–\$90/day | \$2,500–\$4,000     | At 10+ jobs/month         |
| Edge sander                   | \$35–\$50/day | \$800–\$1,500       | At 10+ jobs/month         |
| Floor buffer/polisher         | \$35–\$50/day | \$500–\$1,200       | At 5+ jobs/month          |
| Vacuum (commercial)           | \$25–\$40/day | \$300–\$600         | Buy early — always needed |
| Sanding belts/discs (per job) | N/A           | \$30–\$60/job       | Consumable — always buy   |
| Stain and finish (per job)    | N/A           | \$80–\$150/job      | Per job consumable        |
| Applicators and rags          | N/A           | \$20–\$40/job       | Per job consumable        |
| Respirator + safety gear      | Own it        | \$60–\$120 one-time | Buy before first job      |

## RENTAL COST PER JOB VS JOB REVENUE

400 sq ft job at \$2.50/sq ft = \$1,000 revenue. Equipment rental: \$150. Supplies: \$90. Total cost: \$240. Net: \$760. Rental margin: 76%. Even at full rental cost, hardwood restoration generates exceptional margins. Purchase your equipment only when rental logistics (availability, transport) limit your job capacity or when monthly rental costs exceed \$800 — which happens at 8+ jobs per month.

# Your Service Menu — From Basic Refinishing to Full Restoration

Buffing, screen-and-recoat, full sand-and-finish, and repairs.

Not every hardwood job requires full sanding. Understanding the service tiers allows you to quote accurately, offer the right solution for each client's floor condition, and capture clients whose floors are not yet ready for full restoration but need maintenance now.

| Service                       | When Needed                                     | Time      | Price (per sq ft)   |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------------------|
| Buff and recoat               | Light scratches, dull finish, no deep damage    | 4–6 hours | \$1.00–\$1.50/sq ft |
| Screen and recoat             | Moderate wear, finish failing, no bare wood     | 6–8 hours | \$1.25–\$1.75/sq ft |
| Full sand and finish (clear)  | Deep scratches, bare wood visible, major damage | 2 days    | \$2.50–\$3.50/sq ft |
| Full sand, stain, and finish  | Color change desired + restoration              | 2–3 days  | \$3.00–\$4.50/sq ft |
| Board replacement (per board) | Damaged, water-stained, or missing boards       | Per board | \$15–\$35/board     |
| Subfloor repair               | Squeaky or soft subfloor areas                  | Per area  | \$75–\$200/area     |
| Minimum job charge            | Any job under 200 sq ft                         | N/A       | \$350–\$500 minimum |



# Getting Clients — Caribbean Homeowners with Wood Floors

Where to find clients and how before-and-after photos fill your calendar.

Hardwood restoration clients are homeowners who own properties with existing hardwood floors — and who have been meaning to restore them for years. In Caribbean residential neighborhoods, these clients are abundant. Your marketing strategy leads with before-and-after visual content because no other content type converts a hardwood restoration prospect into a paying client faster.

**1****Before-and-After Photos — Your Entire Marketing Strategy**

A photo of a scratched, dull, water-stained hardwood floor next to a photo of the same floor after professional restoration is your most powerful sales tool in any medium. Post these photos in Caribbean Facebook community groups, on Nextdoor, and on Instagram after every job. Include the square footage, the service provided, and a contact for quotes. Caribbean homeowners who see these photos tag their spouses and message you within hours.

**2****Caribbean Real Estate Network — Your Highest Volume Channel**

Caribbean real estate agents, property managers, and home stagers need hardwood restoration on every property they prepare for sale or rental. A listing with restored hardwood floors sells faster and at higher prices than one with worn, scratched floors — every agent knows this. One agent relationship generates 4–8 hardwood restoration jobs per year from properties in their listing pipeline. Approach every Caribbean real estate agent in your market with your portfolio and your availability.

**3****Caribbean Church Communities — Word-of-Mouth Engine**

A hardwood restoration job completed in a Caribbean homeowner's home is seen by every guest who visits that home for the next 10 years. A Caribbean homeowner who hosts a church gathering, a family dinner, or a community event in their newly restored home tells every attendee who did the floors. Post in Caribbean church community groups: 'Hardwood floor restoration in [area] — before-and-after photos available. DM for a free quote.' Caribbean church communities are your fastest word-of-mouth channel.

## 4

### Contractors and Renovation Companies — Referral Partnerships

General contractors, kitchen renovation companies, and bathroom remodeling firms regularly complete projects in Caribbean homes that include or expose hardwood floors. A referral partnership with 2–3 Caribbean-area contractors generates 8–15 hardwood restoration referrals per year from renovation projects where the homeowner needs their floors done as part of the overall home improvement. Offer a 10% referral fee per completed job to every contractor who sends you work.

#### YOUR BUSINESS WEBSITE — PERSONAL NOTE

A professional website converts prospects who find you online into paying clients without a single cold call. I found it significantly easier to use Lovable — an AI site builder where you describe what you want and it builds a professional site in minutes. No coding required. [caribstream.io/lovable](https://caribstream.io/lovable)

#### REMOTE OS PRO — RUN YOUR OPERATION

Remote OS Pro manages your hardwood restoration job scheduling, client follow-up sequences for annual maintenance recoating, contractor referral tracking, and project-based invoicing — keeping a high-ticket flooring business organized across multiple simultaneous job sites. Client management, recurring service scheduling, automated reporting, and invoicing — all in one system. Setup fee \$297 · Software access \$1,999 · \$500/month. No trial. No refunds. All sales final. [caribstream.io/remoteOS-7X4k9mQ2](https://caribstream.io/remoteOS-7X4k9mQ2)

# Scaling to a Full Flooring Business

Crew, installation, commercial contracts, and compounding income.

A solo hardwood restoration professional handles 2–3 jobs per week at maximum — generating \$5,000–\$9,000/month. Adding a trained crew member allows you to take larger commercial jobs and multiple simultaneous residential projects, doubling your capacity without doubling your personal labor.

- 1

**Train Your First Flooring Technician**  
A motivated person with good attention to detail can be trained to operate sanding equipment, apply stain, and finish coats to your standard within 4–6 weeks of supervised jobs. Pay \$20–\$25/hour or 30–35% of each job. With a trained technician you can take on jobs that require 2-person crews (commercial spaces, large open plans over 1,000 sq ft) and double your weekly job output from 2–3 jobs to 5–6 jobs per week.
- 2

**Add Hardwood Installation — Triple Your Service Value**  
A homeowner whose floors are too damaged for restoration needs new hardwood installed. Adding installation services to your business allows you to capture jobs your current restoration-only menu cannot. Hardwood installation pays \$4–\$8/sq ft for labor — a 500 sq ft installation generates \$2,000–\$4,000 from one job. Take a flooring installation course (\$300–\$600) and practice on 3 personal projects before offering professionally.
- 3

**Commercial Flooring Contracts — Hotels, Offices, and Retail**  
Commercial hardwood floors in hotels, restaurants, office buildings, and retail spaces require annual maintenance buffing and periodic full restoration. A 3,000 sq ft hotel lobby floor restoration generates \$7,500–\$10,500 from one commercial contract. Commercial clients pay within 30 days on invoice, repeat annually, and refer sister properties automatically. Pursue commercial contracts after 18 months of residential experience and when you have a 2-person crew capable of multi-day commercial jobs.

| Scale               | Capacity      | Monthly Revenue   | Net (65% margin) |
|---------------------|---------------|-------------------|------------------|
| Solo                | 2–3 jobs/week | \$5,000–\$9,000   | \$3,250–\$5,850  |
| Solo + 1 technician | 5–6 jobs/week | \$10,000–\$18,000 | \$6,500–\$11,700 |

|                            |                |                   |                   |
|----------------------------|----------------|-------------------|-------------------|
| 2-person crew + commercial | 8–10 jobs/week | \$18,000–\$30,000 | \$11,700–\$19,500 |
| Full company (3 crews)     | 20+ jobs/week  | \$40,000–\$70,000 | \$26,000–\$45,500 |

CARIBBEAN EARNER PRINCIPLE

The great houses of Barbados, the plantation homes of Jamaica, the gingerbread houses of Haiti — Caribbean architecture has always understood that beautiful floors are the foundation of a beautiful home. The Caribbean homeowner who has lived for years with damaged hardwood floors and finally sees them restored understands this viscerally. You are not just refinishing wood. You are restoring something they are proud of. That emotional dimension is why hardwood restoration clients refer more aggressively than clients of almost any other home service.

# Sand It Down. Bring It Back. Build Your Flooring Business.

Every Caribbean home with hardwood floors hiding under rugs is a potential job. Every before-and-after photo you post generates three direct quote requests. Every satisfied Caribbean homeowner tells every guest who admires their floors exactly who did the work. Hardwood restoration rewards skill, precision, and the community trust that Caribbean professionals build naturally.

## YOUR FIRST 30-DAY ACTION PLAN

### Week 1 — Training and first practice job

Watch hardwood restoration YouTube tutorials (Bona and Loba brand channels). Book Home Depot equipment rental. Practice on a family member's floor at cost-only. Document every step with photos.

### Week 2 — First paying clients

Post your before-and-after photos in Caribbean Facebook groups and on Nextdoor. Contact 2 Caribbean real estate agents. Target 2 paid jobs in week 2 at full price.

### Week 3 — Build referral partnerships

Visit 3 Caribbean-area general contractors and kitchen/bath renovation companies. Propose a referral partnership. Ask every completed client for a testimonial and referral.

### Week 4 — Systems and scale

Set up your booking page at [caribstream.io/lovable](https://caribstream.io/lovable). Buy your own commercial vacuum. Begin saving toward purchasing your drum sander.

## KEY RESOURCES AND AFFILIATE LINKS

Business website (affiliate) — [caribstream.io/lovable](https://caribstream.io/lovable) Business operations (affiliate) — [caribstream.io/remoteOS-7X4k9mQ2](https://caribstream.io/remoteOS-7X4k9mQ2) Floor sander rental — Home Depot Tool Rental or Sunbelt Hardwood finishing products — [bona.com](https://bona.com) or [duraseal.com](https://duraseal.com) Hardwood restoration training — [nwfatraining.com](https://nwfatraining.com) (NWFA) Floor stain colors — [minwax.com](https://minwax.com)

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